

Chris Donovan

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SUMMARY

I am a food systems data scientist with an interdisciplinary background in environmental science, economics, and behavior. My strengths include quantitative analysis and modeling, with a particular emphasis on open data and reproducible workflows. I contribute to the advancement of scientific rigor and accessibility by developing and applying methods that enable data to be shared, validated, and used across disciplines. Through this work, I help generate insights that support more sustainable, transparent, and equitable food systems.

EDUCATION

M.S., Community Development and Applied Economics	2024
University of Vermont	
Burlington, Vermont	

Graduate Certificate, Ecological Economics	2024
University of Vermont	
Burlington, Vermont	

B.S., Environmental Science	2019
Emphasis in Conservation Biology	
Prescott College	
Prescott, Arizona	

WORK EXPERIENCE

Food Systems Data Scientist	Sep 2024 - present
Food Systems Research Institute	
University of Vermont	
Burlington, Vermont	

Graduate Research Assistant	Apr 2022 - Aug 2024
Community Development and Applied Economics	
University of Vermont	
Burlington, Vermont	

Rare Plant Survey Crew Leader	Apr 2022 - Aug 2022
Institute for Applied Ecology	
Boise, Idaho	

Precision Restoration Technician	May 2020 - May 2022
The Nature Conservancy	
Lander, Wyoming	

Environmental Services Intern

November 2019 - March 2020

Ocotillo Wells SVRA
Ocotillo Wells, California

Seed Technician

August 2019 - November 2019

Institute for Applied Ecology
Silver City, New Mexico

Botanical Field Technician

May 2019 - August 2019

Great Basin Institute
Las Vegas, Nevada

PUBLICATIONS

Peer Reviewed

Christopher Donovan, Magdalena Eshleman, and Corinna Riginos. Delayed seeding and nutrient amendment seed enhancement technology: Potential to improve sagebrush establishment? *Restoration Ecology*, 32(1):e14046, 2024. ISSN 1526-100X. doi:[10.1111/rec.14046](https://doi.org/10.1111/rec.14046).

Under Review

Christopher Donovan. Bee Communities on Costa Rican Coffee Farms: A National Survey, June 2026.

Christopher Donovan, Tessa Lawler, Isabella Loconte, Polly Ericksen, Gillian Galford, and Matthew McIntosh. Inventory and Evaluation of Metrics for a Sustainability Indicator Framework in the Northeast U.S. Food System. 2026.

CONFERENCES

Barituka Bekee, Christopher Donovan, Tessa Lawler, Andrew May, and Josiah Taylor. Operationalizing economic sustainability: A regional food systems approach, June 2025a. [Conference presentation]. Northeast Agriculture and Resource Economics Association, 2025, Burlington, VT, United States.

Barituka Bekee, Christopher Donovan, Cari Ritzenthaler, and Josiah Taylor. Operationalizing sustainability: A regional food systems approach, June 2025b. [Conference presentation]. Agriculture, Food, and Human Values Society, 2025, Corvallis, OR, United States.

Christopher Donovan. Bee Communities on Costa Rican Coffee Farms: A National Survey, June 2026. [Conference presentation]. Agriculture, Food, and Human Values Society, 2026, Burlington, VT, United States.

Christopher Donovan and Tessa Lawler. Inventory and Evaluation of Metrics for a Sustainability Indicator Framework in the Northeast U.S. Food System, June 2026. [Conference presentation]. Agriculture, Food, and Human Values Society, 2026, Burlington, VT, United States.